

Zohran Mamdani: A New Era [C1]

Analizziamo i passaggi più significativi del discorso di ringraziamento di Zohran Mamdani, il neoeletto sindaco di New York City che ha dato una scossa alla politica statunitense.

Zohran Mamdani's historic election as the mayor of New York City has [shaken the foundations](#) of the US political establishment at a critical time. And not just because he became the first Indian or the first Muslim, and the first self-declared democratic socialist, to lead the city [at the forefront](#) of cultural and economic transformations. His political style and rhetoric — full of idealism and utopian promises — echo the voices of past leaders like Barack Obama or [even](#) Martin Luther King Jr. Mamdani's speech on the night of 4 November has been [hailed](#) as one of the most inspiring in recent memory. Time magazine called it "a moment of generational [shift](#), delivered with the cadence of a movement leader rather than a politician," while Politico defined his words as "a defiant, poetic [rebuke](#) of political convention."

CITY OF IMMIGRANTS

Throughout his campaign, Mamdani often spoke about his immigrant background and visited immigrant neighbourhoods across New York City. In his victory speech, he began by addressing his base, comprised of the more than four million working-class New Yorkers who [keep the city running](#). **Zohran Mamdani (American accent):** For as long as we can remember, the working people of New York have been told by the wealthy and the well-connected that power does not belong in their hands. Fingers [bruised](#) from lifting boxes on the warehouse floor, palms [calloused](#) from delivery bike [handlebars](#), [knuckles scarred](#) with kitchen burns: these are not hands that have been allowed to hold power. And yet, over the last twelve months, you have [dared](#) to reach for something greater. Tonight, [against all odds](#), we have [grasped](#) it. The future is in our hands. My friends, we have [toppled](#) a political dynasty.

LITTLE EGYPT

He then turned to thank the many communities that had embraced his message — making special mention of Steinway Street, an area in the Queens neighbourhood of Astoria known as Little Egypt for its vibrant Arabic-speaking and Middle Eastern immigrant community. **Zohran**

Mamdani: Before I say anything else, I must say this: thank you. Thank you to the next generation of New Yorkers who refuse to accept that the promise of a better future was a relic of the past. You showed that when politics speaks to you without condescension, we can [usher in](#) a new era of leadership. We will fight for you, because we are you. Or, as we say on Steinway, “Ana minkum wa ilaykum.” Thank you to those so often forgotten by the politics of our city, who made this movement their own. I speak of Yemeni [bodega](#) owners and Mexican abuelas. Senegalese taxi drivers and Uzbek nurses. Trinidadian [line cooks](#) and Ethiopian aunties.

A BOLD VISION

Later in the speech, Mamdani referenced Jawaharlal Nehru, a central figure in India’s struggle for independence from British colonial [rule](#) and the country’s first prime minister. Quoting from Nehru’s famous “[Tryst](#) with Destiny” speech, delivered on the [eve](#) of India’s independence in 1947, Mamdani marked the symbolic end of an era in New York politics. **Zohran**

Mamdani: Standing before you, I think of the words of Jawaharlal Nehru: “A moment comes, but rarely in history, when we [step out](#) from the old to the new, when an age ends, and when the soul of a nation, long suppressed, finds [utterance](#).” This will be an age where New Yorkers expect from their leaders a [bold](#) vision of what we will achieve. Central to that vision will be the most ambitious agenda to [tackle](#) the cost-of-living crisis : an agenda that will freeze the rents for more than two million rent-stabilised [tenants](#), make buses fast and free, and deliver universal childcare across our city.

NEW YORKERS

He also made a [pointed](#) reference to Donald Trump, who, like Mamdani, is a product of New York; but whose legacy Mamdani [vowed](#) to dismantle.

Zohran Mamdani: In this moment of political darkness, New York will be the light. As has so often occurred, the billionaire class, they want the people to fight amongst ourselves so that we remain distracted from the work of remaking a long-broken system. Together, we will [usher in](#) a generation of change. And if we embrace this brave new course, rather than [fleeing](#) from it, we can respond to oligarchy and authoritarianism with the strength it fears, not the appeasement it [craves](#). After all, if anyone can show a nation betrayed by Donald Trump how to defeat him, it is the city that [gave rise to](#) him. This is not only how we stop Trump; it's how we stop the next one. We will put an end to the culture of corruption that has allowed billionaires like Trump to evade taxation and exploit [tax breaks](#). We will [stand alongside unions](#) and expand labour protections because we know, just as Donald Trump does, that when working people have [ironclad](#) rights, the bosses who seek to extort them become very small indeed.

THE FINALE

Mamdani ended his speech with a [nod](#) to Mario Cuomo, the long-standing former governor of New York, and father of Mamdani's defeated opponent, Andrew Cuomo. **Zohran Mamdani:** A great New Yorker once said that while you campaign in poetry, you govern in prose. If that must be true, let the prose we write still rhyme, and let us build a shining city for all. I am Muslim. I am a democratic socialist. And [most damning of all](#), I refuse to apologise for any of this! If you want to know more about this topic, read the article Zohran Mamdani: The Mayor Of NYC.

Glossary

- **dared** = osare
- **against all odds** = contro ogni previsione
- **grasped** = afferrare
- **fleeing** = fuggire
- **rebuke** = rimprovero
- **bodega** = negozio di alimentari (termine tipico di New York)
- **craves** = desiderare
- **unions** = sindacati
- **most damning of all** = la cosa peggiore
- **pointed** = pungente
- **vowed** = giurare
- **hailed** = acclamare, elogiare
- **shift** = cambiamento, svolta
- **eve** = vigilia
- **tenants** = inquilini
- **at the forefront** = in prima linea
- **bruised** = malridotte, contuse
- **calloused** = callosi
- **rule** = dominio
- **stand alongside** = stare accanto a
- **nod** = riferimento
- **shaken the foundations** = scuotere le fondamenta
- **knuckles** = nocche
- **toppled** = spodestare
- **usher in** = inaugurare
- **line cooks** = aiuto cuochi
- **Tryst** = incontro
- **tackle** = contrastare
- **step out** = uscire
- **tax breaks** = agevolazioni fiscali
- **scarred** = con cicatrici
- **gave rise to** = dare origine a
- **ironclad** = inattaccabili

- **utterance** = voce, parola
- **bold** = audace
- **keep the city running** = mantenere in funzione
- **handlebars** = manubri